CHAIN OF DRAFT PROMPTING

Chain of draft is an prompting technique where we guide LLM to reason through problems step by step, rather than jumping directly to an answer, keeping reasoning as short , quick , compact and not verbose, capturing only the main points required for problem solving.

Eg:- Think step by step to answer the question but only keep a minimum draft for each thinking step, with 15 words at most. Return the answer at the end of the response.

Questions:- A food scientist is mixing two types of grain. Grain X contains 10 percent protein and Grain Y contains 18 percent protein. How many kilograms of Grain X must be mixed with Grain Y to create a 20-kilogram batch that contains 15.2 percent protein?
Think step by step to answer the question but only keep a minimum draft for each thinking step, with 15 words at most. Return the answer at the end of the response.

CHAIN OF DRAFT PROMPTING TEMPLATES

1. Think step by step, but only keep a minimum draft for each thinking step, with 15 words at most. Return the answer at the end of the response after a separator ####.
   Guidelines:
   Limit each step to 5 words
   Focus on essential calculations/transformations
   Maintain logical progression

2. Think step by step to answer the question but only keep a minimum draft for each thinking step, with 15 words at most. Return the answer at the end of the response.

3. Before answering, outline your logic in a scratchpad block. Use only short bullet points with a maximum of 15 words each. Do not write full sentences. Provide your final response immediately after the block.

4. Provide a step-by-step draft of your logic. Restrict each thinking step to a maximum of 12 words and use abbreviations. Return the final answer at the conclusion.

5. Think step by step to answer the question but only keep a minimum draft for each thinking step, with 15 words at most. Return the answer at the end of the response

DOMAIN SPECIFIC

The Database/Query Draft
think step by step to construct the required query. Outline your logic in a minimum draft, keeping each step strictly under 15 words. Focus your draft purely on identifying necessary tables, joins, and filtering conditions. Return the final SQL query at the very end

The Analytical/Math Draft
Solve the following problem by thinking step by step. Maintain a minimal draft of your reasoning, restricting each step to mathematical notation or a maximum of 12 words. Output the final definitive answer on a new line at the conclusion of your response."

Benefits of Using COD

- Reduced Token Consumption
- Lower Latency
- Cost Reduction
- Easy to use and implement
- Maintained Accuracy [Research Papers]

When to avoid COD

- **Tasks requiring high interpretability:** For use cases like legal or medical document review, audit trails, or regulated environments, verbose reasoning may be essential. In such cases, CoT's more transparent, step-by-step explanations provide better traceability and trust.
- **Small language models:** CoD underperformed on models with fewer than 3 billion parameters. These models lack the instruction-following fidelity and reasoning power needed to execute CoD-style prompts effectively. CoT may yield better results in these cases.
- **Creative or open-ended tasks:** Tasks that benefit from elaboration—like writing, ideation, or user-facing conversations—may lose value if too condensed. CoD is best suited for structured reasoning, logic, and deterministic tasks where brevity improves performance.

- **For tasks where readability matters.**